Armen G. Kaprelian

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Education

Claremont Graduate University 2022 – Expected early 2027
Ph.D., Economics (GPA: 3.88) *Claremont, CA*

- Dissertation: *Opacity and Adaptation under Sanctions: Geoeconomics in the Universe of Russian Firms*
- Among the first firm-level sanctions studies with universal administrative coverage of a target economy: ∼61M firm-year observations across 9.8M Russian firms (2011–2024), processed in R on memory-optimized AWS EC2 instances.
- Methods: event-study and quantile difference-in-differences, discrete-time hazard models, gradient-boosted classification (CatBoost), Olley–Pakes TFP estimation, shift-share IV, spatial Durbin models, coarsened exact matching.
- Fields: geoeconomics, international trade, sanctions and counter-sanctions

George Mason University 2018 – 2020
M.A., Economics (GPA: 3.70) *Arlington, VA*

Arizona State University (Honors College) 2012 – 2016
B.S., Economics (GPA: 3.89) *Tempe, AZ*

Experience

Ministry of Economy of the Republic of Armenia Sep 2020 – Jul 2022
Economic Research Assistant, Economic Research Center *Yerevan, Armenia*

- Co-authored the Ministry's quarterly *Armenian Economic Outlook* report used by Fitch Ratings to evaluate Armenia's sovereign credit rating.
- Estimated trade effects of the Turkey embargo over ∼1,000 6-digit HS-code lines (UN Comtrade, 2018–2021), identifying import substitution and 26% substitute-supplier price inflation (vs. ∼6% globally), and forecasting outcomes of removal.
- Estimated Armenia's incremental capital-output ratio (∼2.3) and a ∼$1B national capital-investment gap benchmarked against 11 peer economies, informing policymaker guidance.
- Modeled the fiscal effects of a proposed 6% payroll-tax health-insurance mandate via domestic consumption functions and shadow-economy dynamics, projecting an annual budget cost near 4% of GDP.
- Evaluated a VAT-reduction proposal to formalize the shadow economy, recommending alternatives after finding only 40–60% consumer pass-through and asymmetric price response.

Center for International Private Enterprise (CIPE) Sep 2019 – Dec 2019
Research Intern, Eastern Europe & Eurasia Department *Washington, DC*

- Authored a report on anti-corruption regulation and its impact on SME capital access across 10 Eurasian nations.
- Proposed, to senior staff and the Executive Director, an approach to integrating climate solutions into CIPE's consulting operations.

Armenian Assembly of America Jun 2019 – Aug 2019
Research Intern, Office of the Nagorno-Karabakh Republic *Washington, DC*

- Produced an investor-facing analysis of emerging industries (renewable energy, banking) and harmonized regional economic and financial data.

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, Econometrics with Linear Algebra (R, Python) — Pomona College Jan 2025 – May 2025
Teaching Assistant, Econometrics II: Causal Inference (R, Stata) — Claremont Graduate University Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

Skills & Languages

Programming	R, Python, Stata, SQL, LaTeX
Computing	AWS EC2 (Linux; containerized RStudio Server for large-scale panel data)
Software	Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint, Word
Languages	English (native), Armenian (conversational)

Fellowships

- **H. Hovnanian Family Foundation Public Service Fellowship**, 2021 — continued government service in Armenia following iGorts.
- **iGorts Fellowship**, 2020 — placing Diaspora Armenian professionals within the Government of Armenia.